

Oberlin is all alone at the top of the LCC

Jerry Rombach
The Chronicle-Telegram

OBERLIN—First place!

"These kids deserve it," Oberlin boys basketball coach Joe Harris said after the Indians polished off visiting Avon 67-46 Friday night to take over sole possession of first place in the Lorain County Conference.

"They've worked hard all year. This group does what it takes to win. They like to play. You have to have that because at this stage of the season it comes down to desire. You can have all the talent

Oberlin	G	F	T	Avon	G	F	T
Hodge	7	4	18	Hayden	4	5	13
Thomas	5	2	13	Benson	4	1	9
Young	5	0	10	Guernsey	1	3	6
Chambers	3	0	8	Vega	3	0	6
Luke	3	1	7	Jones	2	0	5
Barbra	1	2	4	Smith	1	1	3
Gibbs	1	0	3	Paragard	0	2	2
Jackson	0	2	2	Snarey	1	0	2
G Thomas	0	0	2	Crowder	0	0	0
J Chambers	0	0	0	Daniel	0	0	0
Porter	0	0	0				
Wilson	0	0	0				
Totals	25	13	67	Totals	16	12	46

in the world, but it takes desire to win."

With Keystone's loss to Brookside Friday night, Oberlin moved a game ahead of the Wildcats in the standings going into a crucial weekend. The Indians (12-3 overall and 9-2 in the league) play at last-place Wellington on Friday but then host Keystone Saturday. In the earlier meeting Keystone nipped Oberlin by two points, the last defeat for the Indians. They've won five straight since.

Will the Oberlin players take Wellington too lightly, looking ahead to the revenge game with Keystone Saturday?

"Our kids? Every night they come out of the lockerroom door

thinking they're facing the best team they'll play all year."

They also felt that way Friday in downing Avon, which fell to 4-11 overall and is now tied with Wellington for last place in the league with a 2-9 mark. Despite severe foul trouble, which benched 6 foot 7 Michael Young and 6-6 Greg Thomas early, Oberlin led the rest of the game after gaining a 6-4 edge on Young's layup after a lob pass inside Avon's zone with 5:43 remaining in the opening quarter.

The Eagles made some rallies but could never get closer than 11 points from early in the third quarter on.

Their little 5-2 freshman dynamo Steve Vega, averaging 15 points a game, was stopped cold by Oberlin's man-to-man defense, and especially Howard Chambers, who guarded him.

"Howard's goal was to keep the little freshman out of double figures," Harris said. "And he did."

Vega scored only six points and didn't have his first field goal until just 2:05 remained in the third quarter with Oberlin leading by 15 points.

Avon was also hurt by the absence of Troy Duesler, out with an ankle injury. He was the team's leading rebounder and averaged 12 points scoring a game.

"Oberlin played pretty solid

defense throughout the game," Avon Coach Dave Kudela said. "We had early shooting problems and that set the tone. We were too passive."

Both teams didn't shoot well, either from the field or the line. Oberlin hit 33 per cent of its field goal attempts, on 25 of 75 attempts, while missing 13 of the 26 free throw tries. Avon was an ice cold 26 per cent from the field, 16 of 60, and missed 10 of its 22 free throws.

An oddity of the game was the shorter Avon team out-rebounded Oberlin 58-57, thanks to a big 22-rebound fourth quarter when Indian reserves were in. Oberlin had 11 turnovers, Avon 20.

Avon will play at Keystone Friday in its next game.

Wellington rallies to knock off Firelands

Wellington.....64
Firelands.....57

WELLINGTON—After trailing 17-11 after the first quarter, Wellington took command of the boards, helping to forge an upset victory over Firelands in Lorain County Conference boys basketball play Friday night.

The win, only the Dukes' second on the season, was aided by Andy Bragg and Frank Quintana, who grabbed 14 rebounds apiece. Quintana's 13 points were second only to Brian Wheeler's 17 for Wellington (2-15, 2-9).

For Firelands (6-10, 5-6), 23 points by Matt Varndell—including 11 in the third quarter—were not enough to muster the win.

The Dukes resume play next Friday at home to Oberlin, while Firelands entertains Elyria West.

Fire	G	F	T	Well	G	F	T
Potts	2	0	5	Chippell	3	0	6
Collier	3	5	12	Wale	1	2	4
Therby	6	0	15	Swanson	2	1	4
Jansay	1	0	12	Barbor	1	0	2
Vmdell	10	0	23	Davison	1	0	2
				Wheeler	7	0	17
				Kingler	1	4	6
				Quintana	5	3	13
				Bragg	3	2	8
				Wheffett	0	1	1
Totals	22	5	57	Totals	24	13	64

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Fire 17 9 25 6 — 57
Well 11 17 21 15 — 64
Three-point goals: Firelands 8, Varndell 3, Thomsbury 3, Collier, Potts, Wellington, Wheeler 3
Junior varsity: Wellington 49-47

Elyria frosh stop Lorain

LORAIN — Justin Burton and Jeff Cornute combined for 35 points to lead Elyria's freshman boys to a 56-25 win over Lorain Thursday.

The win gives the young Pioneers a 13-1 Erie Shore Conference record and clinches a tie for the league championship.

Elyria, 14-1 overall, plays Lakewood St. Edward at the Lakewood tournament on Saturday



JAMINE EXNER/CHRONICLE

DRIVING: Matt Pedraza of Clearview moves past Elyria West's Darrin Terry during action from his Clippers' 54-52 win Friday.

WOLVERINES

From C1

at the half, but West's continuing problems on the boards allowed the visitors to build a seven point margin several times in the third period

The momentum shifted early in the final quarter when Clearview turnovers brought West back until Woodyard's three tied the game. Russell put his team back on top with a turnaround jumper with 1:54 left. After several possessions, Crutcher hit a jump shot of his own with 14 seconds left to tie the game, but it only set up Russell's heroics.

"We did enough in the second half to get into the game, but we didn't do enough to win the game," Mohr pointed out. "We weren't very consistent tonight. At times we looked very good and other times we looked very sloppy."

The Clippers received balanced scoring as Pedraza finished with 17, Tim Dower added 13 and Russell had 11. Clearview shot a fine 21 of 39 for 54 percent.

Crutcher led West with 22 points on 11 of 16 from the field while point guard Daimion Mahone scored 14. The Wolverines made only 20 of 46, or 43 percent and converted only 10 of 20 free throws.

The Clippers' win raised their Lorain County Conference record

to 6-5, identical to West's mark. Clearview is now 7-10 overall, the Wolverines dropped to 7-9.

The West junior varsity won a two-overtime thriller, 49-45. Jakanda Dickerson and Eric Evans scored 14 and 11 respectively for the winners while Scott Zimmerman had 14 for the young Clippers.

West is back in action tonight when it hosts Lorain in a non-conference game. Clearview is off until Friday when it entertains Brookside.

Players	G	F	A	FT	F	P
Strad Pedraza	14	6	4	3	3	17
Tim Dower	14	6	2	1	3	13
Andrew Alarcon	8	2	0	4	4	2
Ronnie Russell	8	5	3	0	0	7
Robert Russell	8	0	0	0	0	1
Robby Collier	0	0	0	0	0	0
Clint Miller	0	0	0	0	0	0
Jon Drew	0	0	0	0	0	0
Eric Gilbert	0	0	0	0	0	0
Shed Parsons	1	1	0	0	0	2
TOTALS	38	21	14	8	16	54

Players	G	F	A	FT	F	P
Strad Schmitt	1	0	2	2	4	2
Darrin Terry	2	0	4	1	2	1
Daimion Mahone	14	4	11	5	3	14
Nate Crutcher	18	11	0	0	1	22
Brian Jenkins	2	1	0	0	0	11
Jason Woodyard	5	2	0	0	2	6
Ben Pyles	1	0	0	0	0	0
Eric Wooten	3	2	3	2	3	0
TOTALS	46	20	28	10	17	52

Score by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Clearview 12 18 15 9 — 54
Elyria West 14 13 14 11 — 52
Three-Point Goals: Clearview-Matt Pedraza 2, Ronnie Russell, Elyria-West-Daimion Mahone, Jason Woodyard
Junior Varsity: Elyria West, 49-45, 2 o.t.

Winter Fest

The annual Winter Days Festival, sponsored by the Lorain County Parks, will be Saturday and Sunday from noon to 5 p.m., at the Equestrian Center of Diagonal Road.

There will be hay wagon rides, cross country skiing, sledding, ice sculpture demonstration, learning about obtaining maple sugar and a pioneer camping exhibition.

SPORTS CARD
and
COMIC BOOK SHOW
at
SHEFFIELD LAKE COMMUNITY CENTER
Lake Road
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 12th
Hours: 10 A.M.-4 P.M.
FREE ADMISSION

Olmsted Falls.....52
North Olmsted.....47

NORTH OLMSTED—Tim Matus scored all of his team-high 13 points in the second half to lead Olmsted Falls to a Southwestern Conference victory over North Olmsted Friday night.

Tim Schaeffer added 12 points for the Bulldogs, who improved to 12-4 on the season (6-4 SWC). Keith Bielozor (11) and Steve Gdovin (10) combined for 21 points to lead the Eagles (9-7, 5-5).

Olmsted Falls continues conference play at home this evening against Avon Lake, as North Olmsted visits Fairview.

O.F.	G	F	T	N.O.	G	F	T
DeLau	3	2	8	Benedo	1	0	2
Matus	5	2	13	Bleizer	1	4	2
Taber	3	0	7	Moffitt	3	0	8
Moore	1	0	2	Smith	3	2	8
Johnson	1	0	2	Gdovin	3	0	10
Strubir	0	2	2	Pattin	4	0	8
Kennedy	3	0	5				
Schaeffer	5	2	12				
Totals	21	8	52	Totals	20	4	47

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
O.F. 15 7 13 17 — 52
N.O. 10 12 15 10 — 47
Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls 2, Taber, Matus North Olmsted 3, Moffitt 2, Bielozor
Junior Varsity: Olmsted Falls, 49-38.

Brookside drops Keystone to 2nd

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

SHEFFIELD — After being in first place all season long Keystone now finds itself in second looking up to leader Oberlin.

Keystone's offense went sour the second half of a 59-55 boys basketball loss at Brookside Friday, and the bad taste could linger a long while if it costs the Wildcats their chance for a first-ever Lorain County Conference championship.

Brookside dominated the third and fourth quarters after spotting Keystone a nine-point lead at halftime. The Cardinals took 30 field goal attempts in the second half to the Wildcats' 19, outrebounded Keystone 10-3 in the third frame and committed no turnovers in the fourth quarter to six for the Cats.

The loss, Keystone's second in a row, dropped the Wildcats to 8-3 in the LCC, 11-6 overall and a game behind Oberlin, a team they still must play on the road next Saturday. The Cards are 6-11 and 6-5 in the conference.

"Three things did it," Brookside coach Gene Leonard said. "First, Beau and Bobby Rosso did a hell of a job shutting down (Mike) Helbig in the second half and not letting him hit 3-pointers. That was the main thing we talked about at halftime. He couldn't hit anymore threes."

He didn't. Helbig bagged five from long range in the first half, four of them in the opening frame, but scored only four of his team-leading 21 points in the latter half as the Cards used a box-and-one zone defense with great success.

"Second was (Jason) Rodak getting his fourth foul," Leonard added.

Rodak, Keystone's 6-4 center, picked up foul No. 4 with 3½ minutes to play in the second period. He sat through the rest of the first half, all of the third quarter and the first two minutes of the fourth. Rodak had six rebounds at the time of his departure.

"The third thing was Mac

Keystone	G	F	T	Brookside	G	F	T
Helbig	7	2	21	Wright	2	1	5
Johnson	3	0	6	McFeeture	13	0	30
Holzhauer	7	0	14	Ness	8	3	15
Webb	2	0	4	Beau/Rosso	2	1	5
Rodak	2	0	4	Connolly	1	0	2
Sabo	0	0	0	Bobb/Rosso	0	0	0
Gordon	1	0	2	Corvessu	1	0	2
McClelland	0	0	0				
Condit	2	0	0				
Totals	24	2	55	Totals	25	5	59

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Keystone 15 17 10 10 — 55
Brookside 15 11 17 16 — 59
Three-point goals: Helbig 5, McFeeture 4.
Junior Varsity: Brookside, 58-48

(Dave McFeeture). He really lit it up for us."

To say the least, McFeeture scored a career-high 30 points on 13-of-21 field-goal shooting. He put the Cardinals ahead to stay with a basket at 3:46 of the fourth and canned a 3-pointer at 3:02 to give Brookside a 55-51 edge. His hoop at 2:12 made it a six-point difference.

McFeeture's total was the most anyone had scored on Keystone all season. Also scoring a career high was sophomore Darin Ness with 17.

The Wildcats, oddly enough, seemed to do better without Rodak. Keystone lead 24-22 when he went to the bench, then outscored Brookside 11-4 for the rest of the second period. But Rodak's absence was felt in the third quarter, when the Cards dominated the rebounding.

"That was a killer," Keystone coach Greg Morgan said. "We have a chance to win our conference for the first time in 28 years, but those are the breaks of the game. I hope our fans stick with us. I know the team will pull together in the remainder of the year."

Keystone was also without 6-6 Rob Beckham, out with an undiagnosed illness of the throat.

"It's tough to go without those guys," Morgan added. "But look at what they lost. They had little talent to start with, then they lost their No. 2 and No. 3 scorers (Jay Mahon and Mike Finnerty, out since the start of the season), but they're starting to win anyway."

Rodak still finished as the game's top rebounder with eight. Jon Wright paced Brookside with nine assists.

Foul shooting hurt Keystone. The Wildcats were 2-of-11 at the line.

SOUTHWESTERN CONFERENCE ROUNDUP

Westlake68
Rocky River52

ROCKY RIVER—Four Demons scored in double figures to lead first place Westlake past SWC foe Rocky River Friday night.

Chris Holick led Westlake with 14 points, followed by Zac Fiebig with 13. The win kept Westlake (13-3, 8-2) in first place in the SWC. The Pirates (6-10, 2-8), led by Chad Standing's game-high 16 points, were outscored in each quarter en route to their fourth consecutive loss.

The Demons host to Bay tonight, as Rocky River visits Amherst.

Westlake	G	F	T	R.R.	G	F	T
Compton	2	0	4	Calley	2	5	11
Blue	0	2	2	Striding	3	8	16
Holick	2	8	14	Stinger	0	2	2
Fiebig	4	0	13	Kennedy	2	4	8
Meyer	1	0	9	Crane	4	0	8
Houser	1	0	2	Kesic	3	5	11
Fisher	3	6	12				
Hamm	4	4	12				
Totals	21	22	68	Totals	14	20	52

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Westlake 13 17 13 25 — 68
R.R. 12 10 10 20 — 52
Three-point goals: Westlake 4, Dalsey 2, Fiebig, Meyer, Rocky River 4, Standing 2
Junior Varsity: Rocky River 46-40

Amherst.....48
Avon Lake.....47

AVON LAKE—Despite scoring only four fourth quarter points, Amherst used stingy defense in the game's waning moments to hold-off Avon Lake in Southwestern Conference play and stay within a game of leading Westlake.

In the final 04, Avon Lake had two opportunities to tie or take the lead, but both attempts came up short.

Mike May and Mike Cline scored 13 points each to lead the Comets (10-6, 7-3), who remain in second place in the SWC behind

Westlake (13-3, 8-2). The Shoremen, led by Terrence Urig's 16 points, slipped to 8-8 overall (4-6 in SWC).

Amherst continues action at home tonight to Rocky River, as Avon Lake visits Olmsted Falls.

Amherst	G	F	T	A.L.	G	F	T
White	1	0	2	Deasy	3	0	9
Ornesow	3	0	5	Mimsy	2	0	4
May	5	3	13	Mrsanek	6	2	21
Cline	4	3	13	Port	2	0	5
Draga	1	3	5	Kpawku	1	2	4
Nixon	1	0	3	Ung	5	6	16
Morante	3	0	6	Cardea	2	0	4
Totals	21	8	52	Totals	20	4	47

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Amherst 11 11 22 4 — 48
A.L. 5 18 14 10 — 47
Three-point goals: Amherst 3, Cline 2, Nixon
Avon Lake 5, Deasy 3, Hurtanek, Port
Junior Varsity: n/a

Bay73
Fairview55

BAY VILLAGE — Bob Miller knocked down six three-pointers and scored a game high 22 points to lead Bay in Southwestern Conference action Friday.

Miller got plenty of help from Michael Masterson, who had 21 points. Fairview (9-7